Bryan Zhao

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EDUCATION

Saratoga High School **Jun. 2026**
High School Diploma *Saratoga, CA*
- Academic GPA: 3.9 UW/4.5 W; SAT: 1550, 6x Scholar of Distinction, Very High Honors
- Activities: Robotics, Speech & Debate, Journalism, Leadership/ASB, Principal Advisory Board, Volleyball

West Valley College
Dual Enrollment Mathematics *Saratoga, CA*
- GPA: 4.00

EXPERIENCE

Saratoga High School VEX Robotics Program **Aug. 2022 – Jun. 2026**
Co-Founder, Co-President & Team Captain *Saratoga, CA*
- Expanded membership to 40+ active students with 100+ yearly applicants.
- Raised $225,000+ through sponsorships and hosted state-wide scrimmages/tournaments.
- Awards: 2022 & 2025 World Semifinalists + Division Champions, 2024 National Champions (Excellence & Tournament Champions), mentored teams winning 2 State Championships & Worlds Design Award.
    - Skills: C++, CAD (Onshape), Fundraising, Community Outreach

University of California, Santa Cruz **May. 2024 – Feb. 2026**
Research Intern *Santa Cruz, CA*
- Collaborating with professors and PhD researchers on AI + Human Computer Interaction (HCI) projects.
- **Project 1 – Senior Healthcare (Fall Detection & Care Planning):** Developed vision-language and LLM-driven systems to detect falls and generate adaptive care plans.
    - Advised by PhD Orlando Ding and Professor Yi Zhang
- **Project 2 – Dual-Model Distillation:** Built efficient hybrid edge–cloud models for action classification; paper accepted at *NeurIPS 2024 Workshop on Video-Language Models*.
    - Advised by PhD Candidates Orlando Ding and Diji Yang alongside Professor Yi Zhang
- **Project 3&4 – UCSC SIP:** Led workshops on teen wellbeing; prototyped food science journaling tools; currently designing plagiarism detection system separately.
    - UCSC SIP (Science Internship Program) – 9% worldwide acceptance rate
        - Sensory Speculation: Advised by PhD Student Ariel Wang and Professor Christina Chung
        - Enhancing Academic Integrity Systems — Developing Advanced MOSS Tools: Advised by Master's Student Surya Valavala

Stanford Institute for Human-centered Artificial Intelligence (HAI) **Jun. 2023 – Jul. 2023**
Program Intern @ AI4ALL *Remote*
- Selected for internship program (4–6% acceptance rate) with lectures from Prof. Fei-Fei Li and leading AI experts.
- Collaborated with Stanford PhD candidates to model and optimize aircraft taxiing systems using machine learning.

COMMUNITY SERVICE

Saratoga Student Leadership (ASB & Class Office) **Jun. 2023 – Jun. 2026**
Associated Student Body (Student Government) Officer | Jun. 2025 – Present *Saratoga, CA*
- One of 6 ASB Officers in the school, managing 120+ student organizations.
- Consolidated 50+ inactive or redundant clubs, improving quality and sustainability.

Class Officer | Jun. 2023 – Jun. 2025
- Led 2026 Prom planning ($80,000+ budget) and coordinated fundraising events.
- Coordinated class fundraising and homecoming annually.

City Of Saratoga **Jun. 2022 – Jun. 2024**
Youth Commissioner *Saratoga, CA*
- Appointed by City Council as 1 of 11 students citywide.
- Directed the eco-park agricultural subcommittee, leading planning for a $150,000 eco-park to promote environmental awareness.
- Represented youth civic perspective, collaborating directly with councilmembers and community leaders.

Boy Scout Troop 581 **Mar. 2019 – Present**
Prospective Eagle Scout (expected Spring 2026) | Jun. 2025 – Present *Saratoga, CA*
- Organized large-scale outings, from Sierra Nevada expeditions to Florida Keys sailing adventures.
- Designing an Eagle Scout project to expand robotics education access to underrepresented communities

Senior Patrol Leader|2021
- Elected Senior Patrol Leader (Troop Lead), doubling troop membership from 20 → 40+ scouts

SELECTED COURSEWORK

- AP Physics C (Electricity & Magnetism), AP Exam *Expected May 2026*
- AP Physics C (Mechanics), A-, AP Exam *Expected May 2026*
- Linear Algebra (West Valley College), *Expected May 2026*
- Intermediate (Multivariable) Calculus (West Valley College), *Dec 2025* - A
- Elementary Statistics (West Valley College), *Aug 2024* - A
- AP Calculus BC, *May 2025* - 5
- AP Physics 1, *May 2025* - 5
- AP Computer Science A, *May 2024* - 5
- AP Physics 2, *May 2025* - 4

AWARDS/HONORS

- 2022 + 2025 VEX Robotics World Championship Division Champions - 20/20,000 Teams+ (Top 0.1%)
    - World Semifinalist Alliance Captain - 4/20 Teams **(Top 0.02% in the World)**
- Paper accepted in NeurIPS 2024 Workshop on Video-Language Models - 56/204 (Leading AI Conference)
- 2024 VEX Robotics U.S. Open Excellence Award (Highest Team Honor) - 1/2000+ Teams, Top 0.05% in United States; Tournament Champions - 2/2000+ Teams; 2025 Skills Champions - 1/2000+ Teams
- Prospective Eagle Scout (highest rank in Scouts of America, expected Spring 2026)
- Scholastic Art and Writing Awards Photography Contest Silver Key (Top 8%)

SKILLS & INTERESTS

- **Skills:** Python, C++, Java, Arduino, Raspberry Pi, CAD (Autodesk Onshape), Journalism
- **Interests:** Photography, Hiking, Volleyball, Cooking, Gym